HEROES OF NORMANDIE

NIJMEGEN 44

SPECIAL 75TH ANNIVERSARY CAMPAIGN

WRITTEN AND DESIGNED BY THIA

HEROES SYSTEM™
TACTICAL SCALE

DEVIL PIG GAMES

HEROES OF NORMANDIE

NIJMEGEN 44



September 1944. After "Operation Cobra" and the ensuing breakthrough, the Germans got a taste of their own medicine as they suffered the Allied version of "Blitzkrieg". Alas, the momentum of this grand offensive has petered out. Even though beyond expectations, the port of Antwerp was captured intact, access to this harbor is obstructed since the Germans are still in control of the mouth of the river Scheldt. Therefore most of the allied supplies must still be conveyed from Cherbourg and not enough reaches the frontlines to support both Patton's and Montgomery's troops simultaneously. The latter, intending to end the war by Christmas, presents Eisenhower with an audacious plan: "Operation Market Garden".

Three airborne divisions (101st US, 82nd US, and the 1st UK) shall be dropped over the regions of Eindhoven, Nijmegen and Arnhem in order to capture vital bridges. The XXX Corps, joined by the Guards Armored Division, 43rd (Wessex) Division and 8th Armoured brigade, was tasked to drive from the banks of the river Scheldt all the way up to Arnhem to relieve the paratroopers while also creating an invasion route into Germany to encircle its industrial heartland, the Rührgebiet.

The 82nd US Airborne division commanded by General James M. Gavin (nicknamed "Slim Jim") is in charge of the Nijmegen sector. His mission is to capture the key bridges across the river Maas at Grave, those crossing the Maas/Waal canal and the one spanning the river Waal in Nijmegen. All the while maintaining a defensive front facing the German border, they are to hold until relieved by British armor units.

VICTORY CONDITIONS FOR THE CAMPAIGN

VICTORY POINTS

The winner of a scenario gains **3 CVPs** (Campaign Victory Point).

A draw yields **1 CVP** to both players.

The player with the most *classic* victory points (following the Free Battle Mode rules) gains **1 Bonus CVP**.

The player with the most Campaign Victory Points at the end of the campaign is declared the winner of the campaign.

The loser of a scenario randomly draws a Tactical Bonus Marker which can be stored (maximum 2), or used in a future scenario in the campaign.

GAME MODES

Nijmegen 44 can be played in three different ways:

a) All scenarios of the entire campaign
b) All scenarios of one chapter
c) All scenarios of one day



SPECIAL RULES

The following special rules apply to all scenarios in this campaign.

RULE #1

BAZOOKAS, PANZERFAUSTS & PANZERSCHRECKS

In Heroes of Normandie the usage of anti-tank weapons against infantry is downplayed by the rules and the abilities of the weapon. However, lightly weaponed paratroopers often used their anti-tank weapons against structures with units inside.



The Destruction special ability value of Bazookas and Panzerschrecks is increased to 2.

If the target is behind a wall, in a building or in a bunker and, benefits from the protection of one of these Terrain Elements, **the Combat Value against infantry is increased to 3 (Panzerfaust) or 2 (Bazooka & Panzerschreck).**

RULE #2

PRESET GERMAN ANTI-TANK CANONS

As soon as German troops had a bit of time to prepare their defense, they established firing plans for their heavy weapons in order to maximise their shots.



When a German anti-tank canon shoots for the first time in a scenario, **it benefits from a +1 bonus to its die roll**.

Mark the target square with a token of your choice in order to remember which square the canon fired at.

Thereafter the canon will only benefit from that +1 bonus to its die roll when it fires at the marked square.

RULE #3

BREACHING WALLS

American paratroopers and engineers can use explosives like **Hawkins Mines** and **Demolition Charges** to place **Breach Markers** from the inside of buildings.

Additionally, they also gain the **Demolition** special ability (Compendium p.40, SME p.4).

A newly placed Breach Marker automatically adds a second Breach Marker of the same value on the adjoining wall of an adjacent building.



RULE #4

GRAIN FIELDS

In September 1944 the grain fields were already harvested.

Treat all grain fields as clear terrain; ignore all Line of Sight penalties.



RULE #5

LEVEES

Obviously, in 1944 there were no hedgerows in Holland Nevertheless there was a terrain element with similar specifics: levees.

Hedgerow squares are considered as levee squares.

Levees are squares at level 1.

The green coloured border of hedgerow squares is replaced by the red Contour Line of an **elevation** (Compendium p.18, D-Day p.2).

Normal elevation rules apply with the following additions:

DEFENSIVE BONUS

- **Ignore the bocage's regular defensive bonus of +2.** When shots **cross** the red elevation contour line of a levee, **a defensive bonus of +1 is added to the defender on the levee** (shooting upwards).

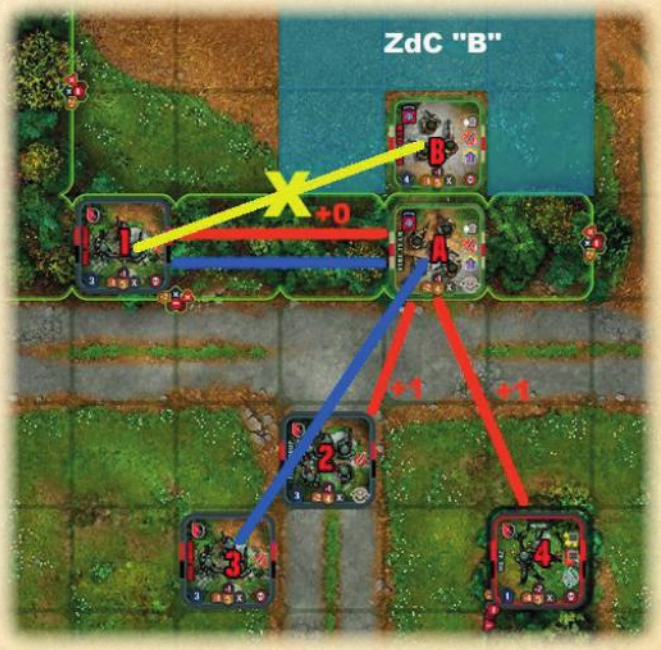
Some examples:
- Unit 2 or 4 shoots at unit A: +1 defensive bonus
- Unit 1 shoots at unit A: +0 defensive bonus
(the shot does not cross a red elevation line)

LINE OF SIGHT

- **Levees don't block LoS between two units situated on a levee.**
- Units don't exercise a Zone of Control on higher levee squares.
- Contrarily to the rules and because levees are at a higher level, infantry units on the lower level don't block Line of Sight.
- **As always, Vehicles block Line of Sight.**

Some examples about Line of Sight:
- Unit A has LoS to units 2 and 3
- Unit 3 has LoS to unit A
- Units 1 and B don't have Line of Sight because the red contour line is crossed.

The American character trait **Sprinter** cannot be used to cross a levee.



RULE #6

AMERICAN RECRUITMENT TILES



All American Recruitment Tiles (including Heroes/ Characters) are considered to be part of the 82nd Airborne Division and are therefore expected to have their division badge (shown on the right) instead of their regular badge.

RULE #7

ALLIED ACTION CARDS & ORDER TOKENS

In scenarios where both American and English units are present, they share the same Action Cards and Order Tokens.

Use the Actions Cards and Order Tokens of the American army.

RULE #8

CONCEALED OPTION

In scenarios where the **Concealed** option is available, it can already be used during deployment.
This option is very useful to camouflage an anti-tank canon, which would normally be given away by its token size.



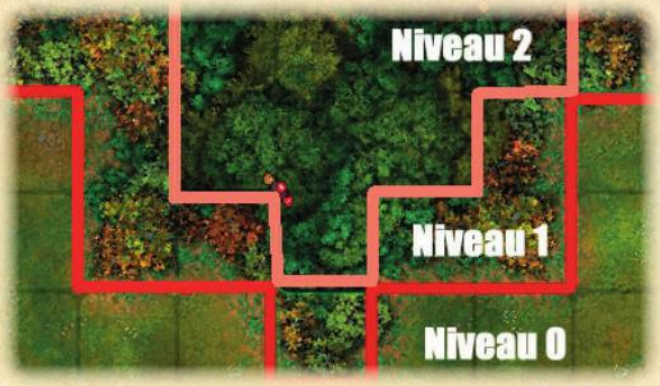
RULE #9

HILLS

Certain scenarios introduce hills. When the rules for hills are used, the colored borders of forest squares are considered as **Contour Lines** and seperate different elevations.

Squares outside the forest are at level 0, the outside of the forest is at level 1 and the heart of the forest is at level 2.

Normal **elevation** rules are applied between each level (Compendium p.18, D-Day p.2).



RULE #10

BOATS



The unit that transports the dinghy is indicated with the small dinghy marker (size of a grenade marker).

Carrying the dinghy, a unit's movement value is reduced by 2 and it cannot traverse bocage squares or enter a building.



A unit with a dinghy cannot take Firing Actions but can execute Movement Actions in the Activation and Supply Phase. During such a Movement Action, you can deploy the boat by removing the dinghy marker and placing the dinghy token on an adjacent river square. This deployment can also be done in the Supply Phase.

When the unit carrying the boat is destroyed, leave the dinghy marker on the square the unit occupied when it was destroyed.

The English boats used throughout the assault of the river Waal were made of plywood; **as a consequence dinghies in this Nijmegen 44 campaign have two Life Points and Transport capacity of 6.**

RULE #11

URBAN AVENUES

Nijmegen, like all big cities, is characterised by its wide and large avenues.

In chapters 6 and 7, roads are considered as **Urban Avenues**. In that case, a wreck on a road square is **not impassible**. However, two stacked wrecks on the same road squares do block movement normally.



NIJMEGEN 44 - SCENARIO 1 - BRIEFING

COUP DE MAIN

September 17, 1944, Grave 1300 hrs: While the Rhine remains the largest river in their path, the Allies first need to cross one almost as large, the river Meuse. While the capture of the Grave bridge is crucial to the success of Market Garden it is critical to the survival of the 82nd. The main body is dropped over the fields near Overasselt on the East side of the river. At 1231 hrs, Lieutenant John Thompson lands in Dropzone (DZ) E with troops of E company on the West bank, with the mission to capture the other end of the bridge as well as the nearby town of Grave in order to prevent the enemy's approach. All went according to General Gavin's orders, *"Drop close to the objectives, launch an immediate assault and capture the bridge from both sides."*



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of E Company, 2/504th Parachute Infantry Regiment









Elements of Landesschützen Ersatz Regiment 6



2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Panzerfaust, Ram, Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Booby Trapped, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Return to Sender, Repairs, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The Americans deploy by airdrop with the following modification. Roll a die to determine the landing point and dispersion. On a result of **6** the player chooses the landing spot of the unit.

The Germans are deployed in their deployment zone. The **FlaK 38** must be positioned in the Defensive Position terrain element and is considered a **Flakturm** (see particular information).

The MG42 group and the Opel Blitz enter during Turn 3 from the Southside.

Germans deploy first, Americans have the Initiative. Put the US initiative marker on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

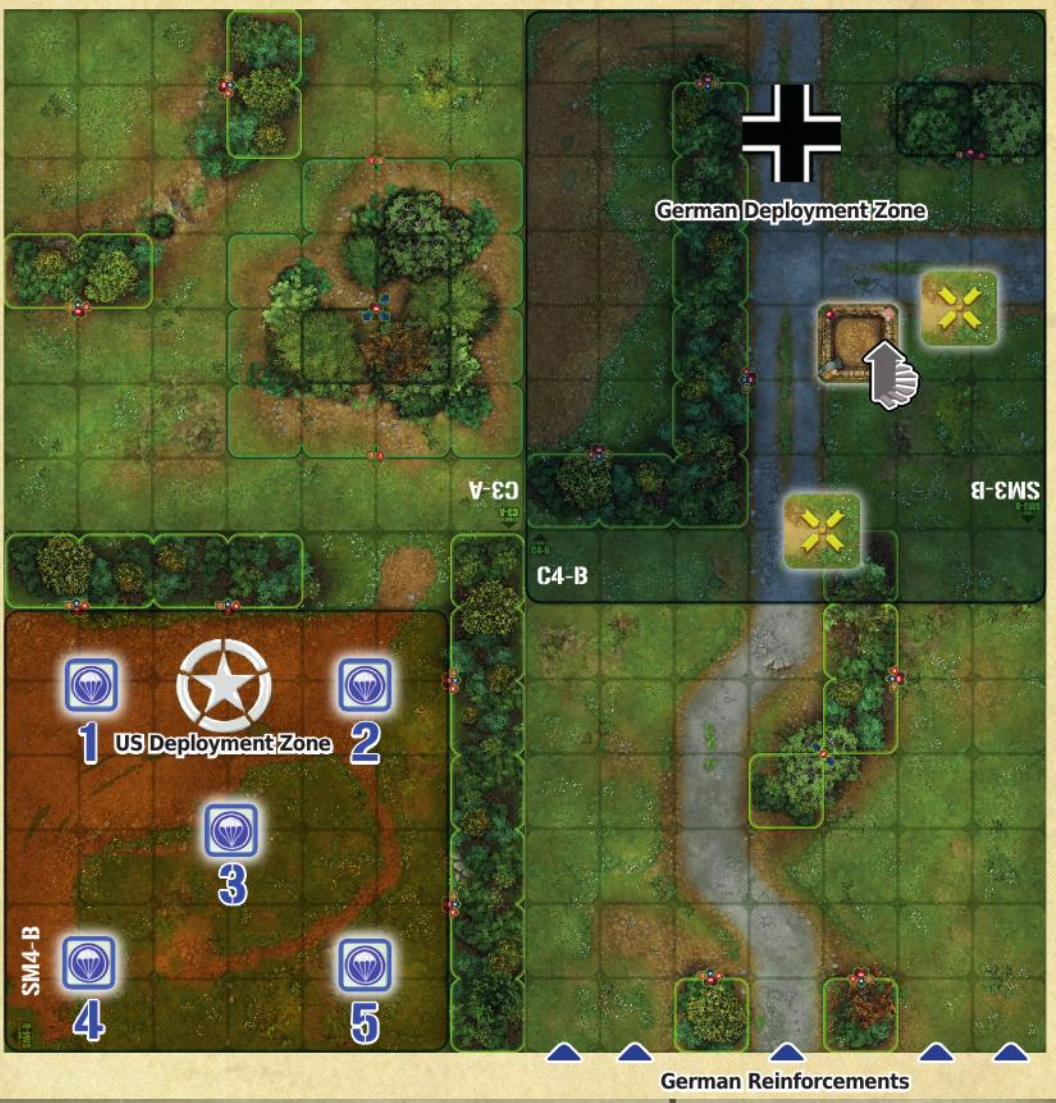
American Victory: if the paratroopers succeed in destroying the FlaK 38 and control at least one of the Objectives at the end of the game.

German Victory: if the Americans fail to achieve their goals by the end of Turn 6.

SCENARIO RULES

The "FlaKTurm" (AA Gun tower) is a **Elevated Position**. The **FlaK 38** unit is the only unit allowed to be placed in the Defensive Position with the Elevated Position ability. The FlaK 38 can neither leave the tower, nor use its Ambush special ability. Its minimum firing range is 3 squares, as it is unable to aim its barrel any lower. It cannot be assaulted and may not be targeted with grenades either. The FlaKTurm is a Structure with a value of 3, destroy it to knock out the FlaK 38 as well.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

As the stream of aircraft approached, standing in the leading C-47's door, first man to jump, Lieutenant John Thompson saw the bridge. Swiftly they were out, descending in full view of the objective, fire coming from the outskirts of Grave and from four anti-aircraft positions on the bridge.

Lieutenant Thomas, tasked to take the bridge, quickly assembled his platoon and set off towards his objective using the numerous drainage ditches as cover. Fire from the wooden flak towers was passing over their heads. In cover behind sandbagged walls the AA crew could engage aircraft with 20mm weapons but were unable to fire at ground troops below as these neared the base of the structure.

Two German trucks roared up the bridge's approach road from the direction of Grave. Bursts of machine gun fire caused the trucks to career off the embankment. Two shots from a Bazooka put the tower crew out of action. Along with two platoons, Thompson controlled the Westside of the bridge.

NIJMEGEN 44 - SCENARIO 2 - BRIEFING

THE ASSAULT OF FOX COMPANY

September 17, 1944. Grave 1300 hrs: As E company was dropped at the Westside of the bridge, the main body of 2/504th landed to the North in DZ O (Oscar) half an hour after the Pathfinders.

Joe Watts of Fox: *"It was a daytime jump, very unusual, but we had the advantage of Air superiority. That being said, we were more unnerved by the name of our objective: GRAVE! We jumped from an altitude of 800 to 600 feet. Upon landing, I heard small arms fire. Looking around to see whence that came from, I spotted a C47 as it got hit by Flak."*

Fox has to capture the Northside of the bridge at Grave.





1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of F Company, 2/504th Parachute Infantry Regiment







Elements of Landesschützen Ersatz Regiment 6



2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Booby Trapped, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Germans deploy first, Americans have the Initiative. Put the US Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

American Victory: if the paratroops succeed in controlling at least two out of three Objectives at the end of the game.

German Victory: if the Americans fail to achieve their goals by the end of Turn 6.

SCENARIO RULES

This scenario can be played simultaneously with 2, 3 or 4 players. Americans must achieve their goals from both scenarios in order to be Victorious. If they fail to do so, the game ends in a draw.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

Approaching the Northside of the bridge with Fox Company, Joe Watts states:

"We were alerted by mortar fire but it didn't seem to be targeting us. Shots were definitely fired in our direction from the other bank, luckily they were aimed too high. At about 200 yards from the river we could see Krauts moving in and out of a brick building. We left the road, went through the woods to get behind the structure. We got into position and attacked, the enemy only fired sporadically."

Fox reached the bridge, swiftly capturing it intact, despite the demolition charges that were placed upon it.

SECURING THE TOWN OF GRAVE

September 17, 1944. Grave 2000 hrs: Towards the end of the day, E and F companies got busy consolidating their position and demining the bridge. Since they were still under fire from the Germans at Grave, Johnson ordered his men to fall back one kilometer. Whilst Company E wasn't out of enemy gun range yet, Dog company crossed the bridge en route to attack the town of Grave.



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES



Elements of D Company, 2/504th Parachute Infantry Regiment





Elements of Landesschützen Ersatz Regiment 6



2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point,
as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Booby Trapped, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Weak Point,
as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Germans deploy first, Americans have the Initiative.
Put the US Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

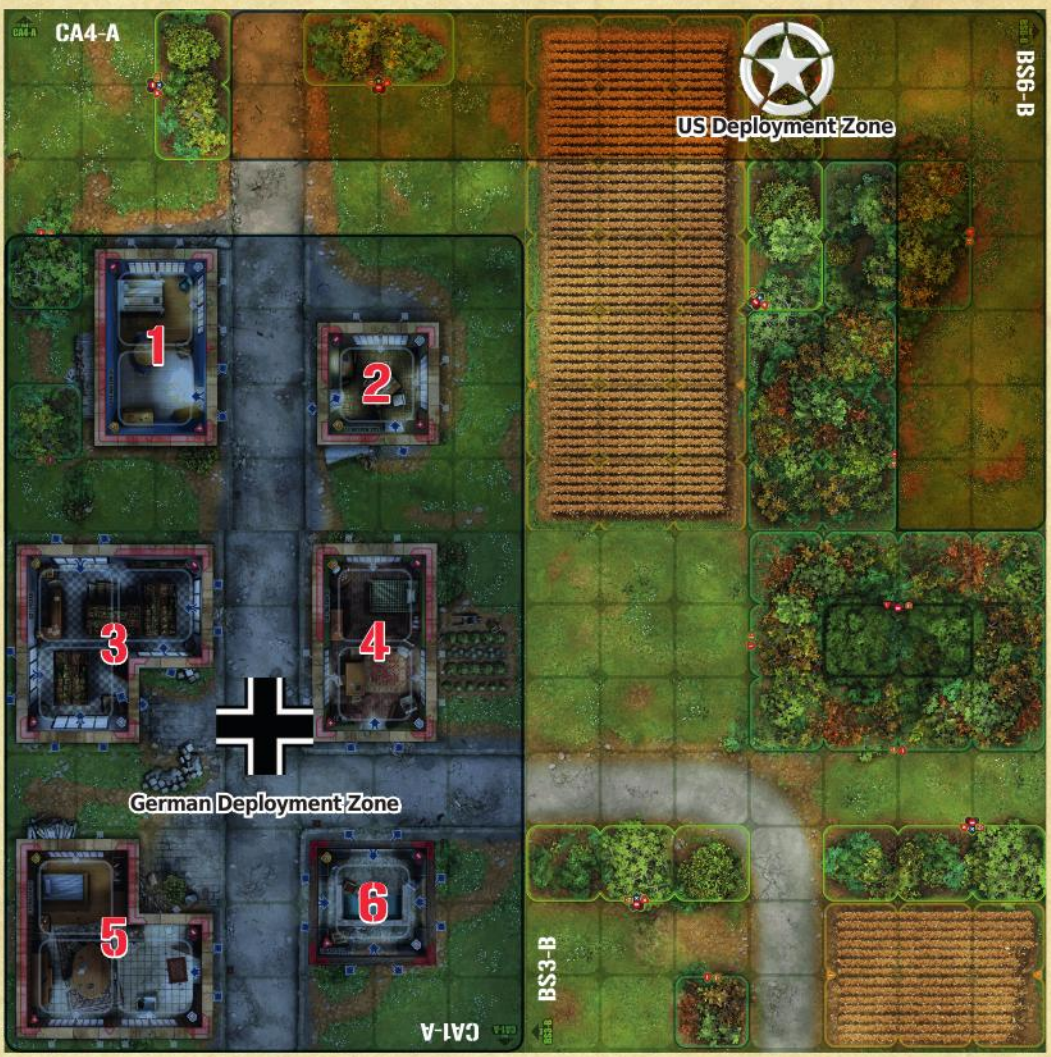
3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

American Victory: if the paratroops succeed in controlling at least 4 of the 6 buildings in the German deployment zone at the end of the game.

German Victory: if the Americans fail to achieve their goal by the end of Turn 6.



4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

Upon approaching the Town of *Grave* the Americans came under fire from enemy machine guns and mortars. Nonetheless, the German defenders, outnumbered and unnerved by the assault on the bridge, were chased out of town by the determined paratroops. In the night of the 18th they got the news that XXX corps was due to arrive the next morning.

On Tuesday, September 19th, at 0820 hrs, the vanguard of B Squadron 2nd household Cavalry Regiment found the bridge at *Grave* intact and secured by the Americans. Quite an achievement, no doubt. Following a brief pause, word was received that the bridge across river Waal in Nijmegen had also been captured. Alas, this information proved to be quite incorrect.

HEUMEN, BRIDGE N°7

September 17, 1944. Heumen 1230 hrs: The Pathfinders were the first to land at DZ O (Oscar) at 1231 hrs, followed shortly by the drop of the 504th. Their target was designated as bridge №7 in the planning, a lock bridge at Heumen capable of taking even the largest river barges. This crossing was the goal of company B of the 1/504th PIR commanded by Captain Thomas B Helgeson. Alarmed upon seeing the sky filled with enemy paratroopers, the German defenders scampered to take up positions on the island between the lock and the sluice channel.



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of B Company, 1/504th Parachute Infantry Regiment





Elements of 2/505th Parachute Infantry Regiment







Elements of Landesschützen Ersatz Regiment 6







2- PREPARATION



Remove from the American deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Panzerfaust, Ram, Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Return to Sender, Ram, Repairs, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

- The American player deploys **B Company, 1/504th** in US deployment zone 1.
- The **2/505th** is deployed in US deployment zone 2 during turn 4.
- The **Germans** are deployed in their deployment zone (see Scenario Rules).



Germans deploy first, Americans have the Initiative. Put the US Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY



American Victory: if the paratroops succeed in controlling at least two out of five objectives at the end of the game. At least one of the controlled objectives must be a Primary Objective.

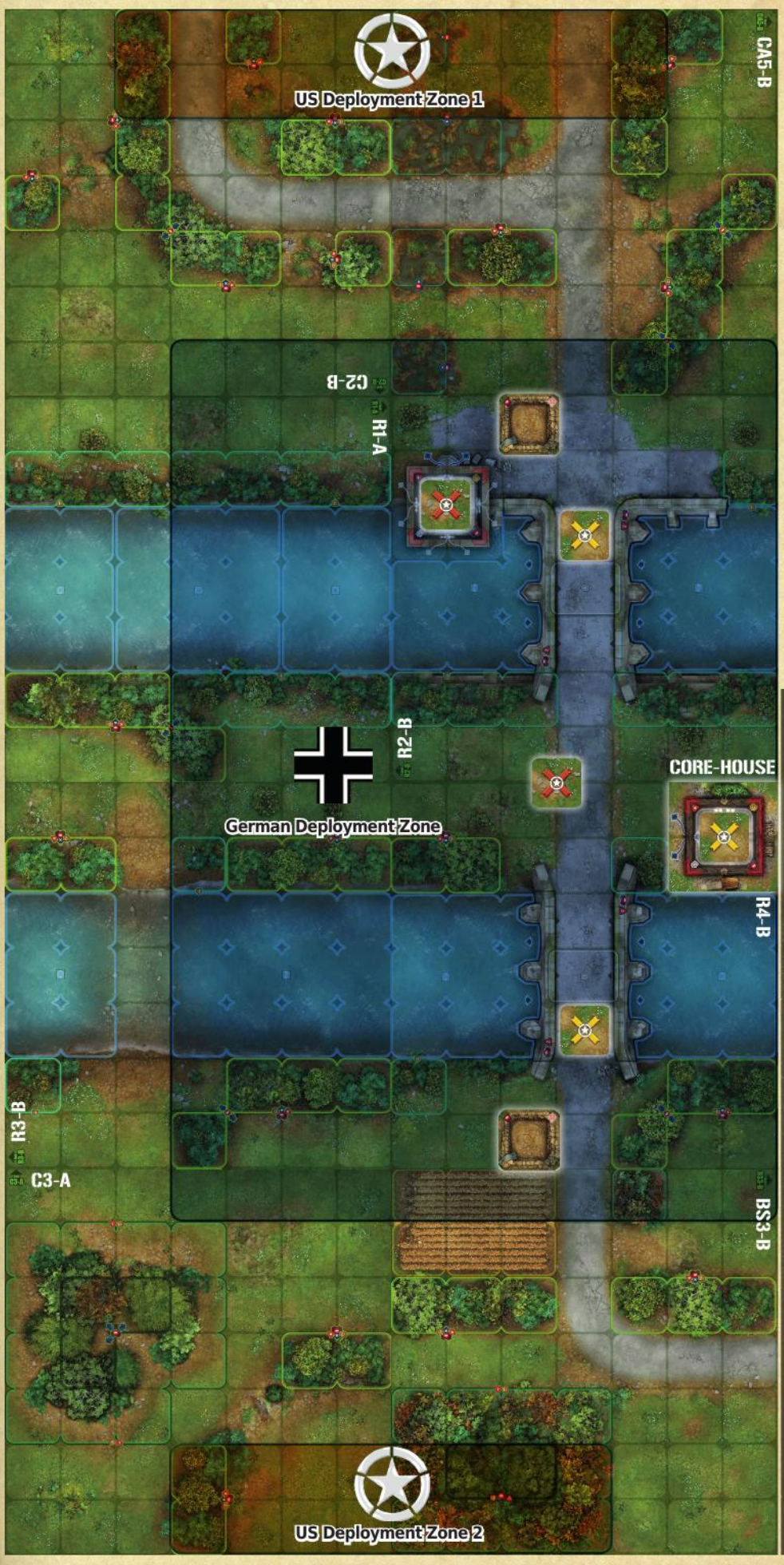


German Victory: if the Americans fail to achieve their goals by the end of Turn 7.

SCENARIO RULES

- The Germans must place an MG42 in each of the Defensive Positions at either end of the lock bridge.
- No more than 4 German units are allowed to be deployed on the island.
- None of the Germans can enter US deployment zone 2 during the game.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT





EPILOGUE

Starting from the East bank, aided by covering machine gun fire, Company B and several engineers cut every wire they came across to prevent the Germans from blowing up the bridge.

According to the commander of 1/504th: *"The soldiers worked frantically, knowing that, if the bridge should explode, they would go up along with it."*

The paratroops pinned down the Germans with sustained fire whilst neutralizing the personnel of an old Russian anti-tank gun. The ensuing stalemate was broken when the 2/505th joined the fight. They were supposed to land at nearby DZ November but, to avoid the congestion there, they were dropped close to Kamp in DZ Tango instead, about 6 km northeast of Groesbeek. They had to hoof it an extra 3 km before attacking the bridge's defenders in the rear. As the Germans were now surrounded, their defense collapsed. At 1800 hrs, General Gavin got word that the bridge at Heumen was captured intact. It seemed the 82nd had secured a route for XXX corps towards Nijmegen. Alas, it was quite uncertain whether bridge №7 could withstand the weight of the British armored vehicles. More than ever, the capture of bridge №10 at Neerbosch/Honinghuite had become paramount.

NEERBOSCH/HONINGHUITE, CROSSING N°10

September 18, 1944. Neerbosch/Honinghuite 0330 hrs: During the evening of September 17, companies E and C of 1/504th approached bridge №8, only to see it being blown to smithereens. Before the eyes of the onrushing paratroops, German demolition squads made sure №9 was also blown sky-high. Lt Lloyd Polette, with first platoon of E, 2/508th didn't make it there till after the explosion. Hardly engaged in combat so far, they were the first to reach crossing №10, the secondary objective of company C, 1/504th and E, 2/508th, consisting of both a road and a railway bridge at Neerbosch/Honinghuite. According to General Gavin, one suitable spot where the hefty tanks could traverse the channel.

Well aware of the crossing's strategic importance, the Germans had bolstered its defenses with bunkers and barbed wire. Preparing their surprise assault, the US paratroops drew nearer with great discretion...



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of E Company, 2/508th Parachute Infantry Regiment









Elements of Landesschützen Ersatz Regiment 6





2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Germans deploy first (see Scenario Rules).

Americans have the Initiative.
Put the US Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.



3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

Victory goes to the player in control of three out of the four Objectives at the end of the game.
Control is kept even if the Objective is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control.

All four Objectives are controlled by the Germans at the start of the game.

Once controlled, Objectives are not removed from the board.

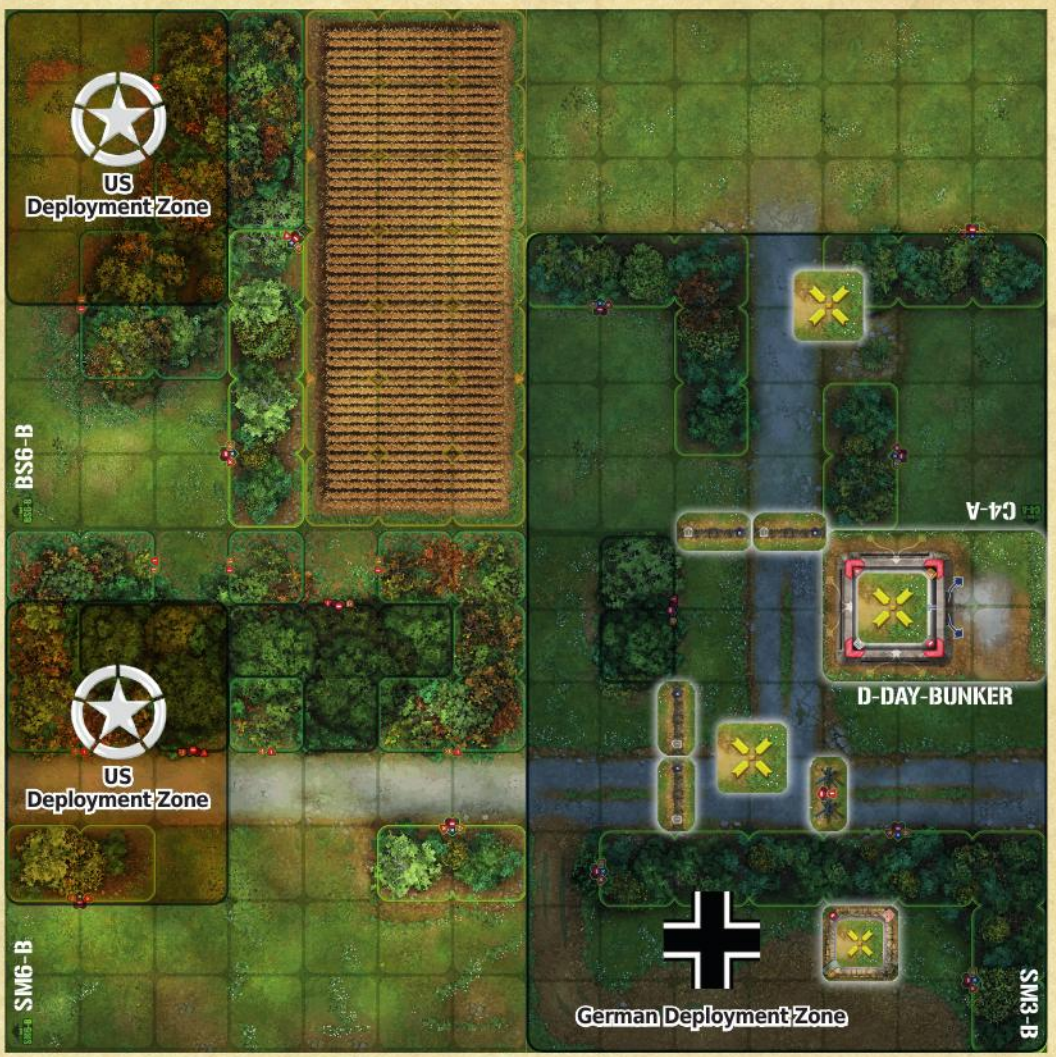
SCENARIO RULES



Clear Night conditions apply.

Germans: Their **MG42 HMG** is placed in the bunker and their **8cm Granatwerfer** deployed at the Defensive Position. These units cannot make any movement other than a Change of Orientation on the spot. **Recon** units must refrain from using their **Scout** ability.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT









EPILOGUE

The Germans, supported by mortars, had the paratroops pinned down. As US casualties began to rise, Lt Polette got a radio message through to Lt Tomlison, C company, 1/504th, whose men were already heading towards crossing №10 after №9 had exploded. At 1030 hrs the railroad bridge was blown up. The road bridge wasn't reduced to rubble but suffered damage. At 1100 hrs, the tide of battle shifted as Lt Tomlison and Lt Polette joined forces in a coordinated attack, supported by an 81mm mortar.

The Germans, now outnumbered, retreated southwest.

When the Household Regiment reached the crossing on the morning of the 19th, they deemed the damaged bridge unsuitable for vehicles. If it were to be repaired, route "Club" towards Nijmegen could be used, but as it stood for the moment, XXX corps had to make do with the smaller bridge at Heumen, further South.

SECURING THE LZ

September 18, 1944. East of DZ N 1240 hrs: Whilst the first day had been quite calm for the 505th, the second day would prove to be quite different. At 0730 hrs, 1st Battalion reported seeing enemy infantry approaching its positions. The designated landing zone, where the gliders with the reinforcements of the "Second Lift" were supposed to touch down at 1300 hrs, was threatened. Thus around 1240 hrs, Captain Anthony Stefanich with Company C had little time to secure the LZ...



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of C Company, 1/505th Parachute Infantry Regiment





Elements of Kampfgruppe Gobel, 406. Infanterie-Division



2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Bogged Down, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Panzerfaust, Ram, Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Booby Trapped, Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Return to Sender, Surprise, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Germans deploy first in their deployment zone and have the Initiative.
Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Americans deploy next (see Scenario Rules).

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

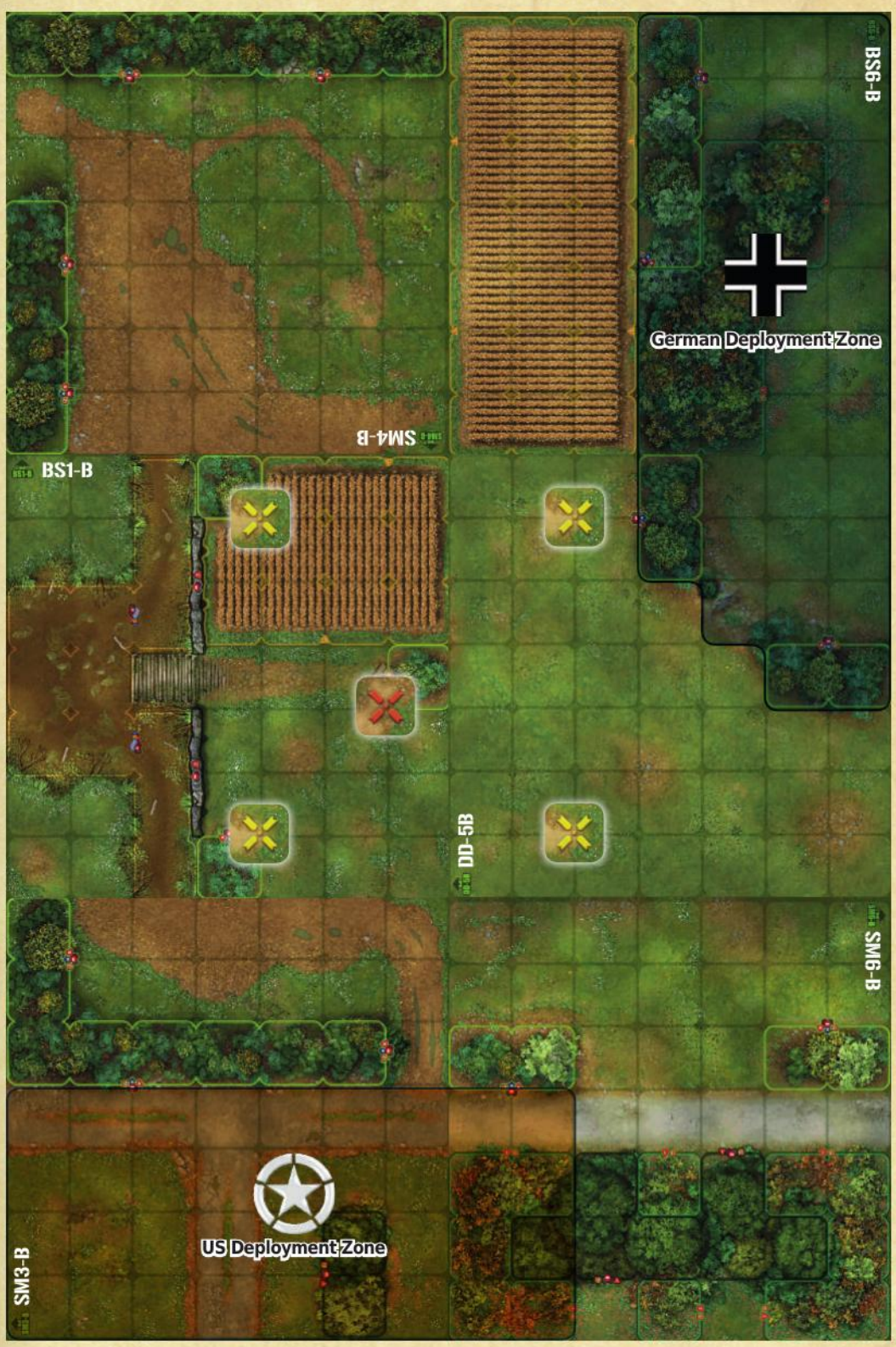
3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

Victory goes to the side controlling the Primary Objective and at least two Secondary Objectives at the end of the game.

SCENARIO RULES

The **US Recon** units cannot use their **Scout** ability during deployment.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

C company only had about half an hour to set things straight before the arrival of the gliders.

Private Allen Langdon recalls: *"The day after our drop more gliders were inbound and we had to scurry to secure the LZ because Germans had largely taken control of the spot. Whilst planes were touching down, we lost Captain Stefanich as he was trying to save a glider that had landed somewhat out of our zone. His last words:* ***We have come a long ways together. Tell the men to do their job well****."*

Thanks to C company's decisive action, the Germans were driven away from the LZ.

A QUIET DAY ON THE FRONT

September 19, 1944. Between Mook and Riethorst:
The 406. Infanterie-Division was made up of any units that were available in the area, including trainees from the zone of Wehrkreis VI. They were thrown into battle as soon as they arrived in the Reichwald region. Hence this division lacked cohesion, strength, and organization.
In spite of this, Kampfgruppe Gobel mounted an attack near Riethorst in the sector of 1/505th PIR.



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of the 1/505th Parachute Infantry Regiment











Elements of Kampfgruppe Gobel, 406. Infanterie-Division





2- PREPARATION



Remove from the American deck:
Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Weak Point,
as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Americans deploy first in their deployment zone.

Germans enter through the squares denoted by arrows.



Germans have the Initiative
Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

***Note** that the buildings are overlays and not the regular houses already printed on the map!*

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

Victory goes to the side controlling three out of the four Objectives at the end of the game.

The Americans are in control of all four Objectives at the start of the game.

SCENARIO RULES

- **Lt Col. Vandervoort** has 4 Movement Points instead of 2 as indicated on his counter.
- **Sgt. Brady** can direct fire for an off-map 75mm Pack Howitzer (use the orange +4 +3 +1 template). He needs an Order Token and Clear or Obscured LoS to his target.
- Once controlled, **Objectives** are not removed from the board. Control is kept even if the Objective is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

KG Gobel's progress was stopped by camouflaged paratroops lying in ambush at towns and along forest roads. The German panzers were terribly hindered when trying to move off road thus becoming easy prey for US bazookas. The German attack was broken by the 82nd's Artillery, flown in the night before with gliders. The paratroops had the presentiment things might go awry the next day.

KG HERMANN ATTACKS

September 20, 1944. Riethorst 1000 hrs: During this stage of the battle, the Germans were determined to destroy the Bridge near Heumen since they realized how crucial it was now for the Allies. At 1000 hrs the 1/505th, positioned in Riethorst and Mook, faced the attack of regiment sized Kampfgruppe Hermann. Under the command of the 406. Infanterie-Division, this KG came from Cologne and was composed of trainees and whatever actual paratroopers were left of the 5. Fallschirmjäger-Division.



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of B & C Companies, 1/505th Parachute Infantry Regiment







Elements of Kampfgruppe Hermann, 406. Infanterie-Division











2- PREPARATION



Remove from the American deck:
Don't Stop, Hit and Run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Weak Point,
as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



Germans deploy first in their deployment zone and have the Initiative.
Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Americans deploy next (see Scenario Rules).

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

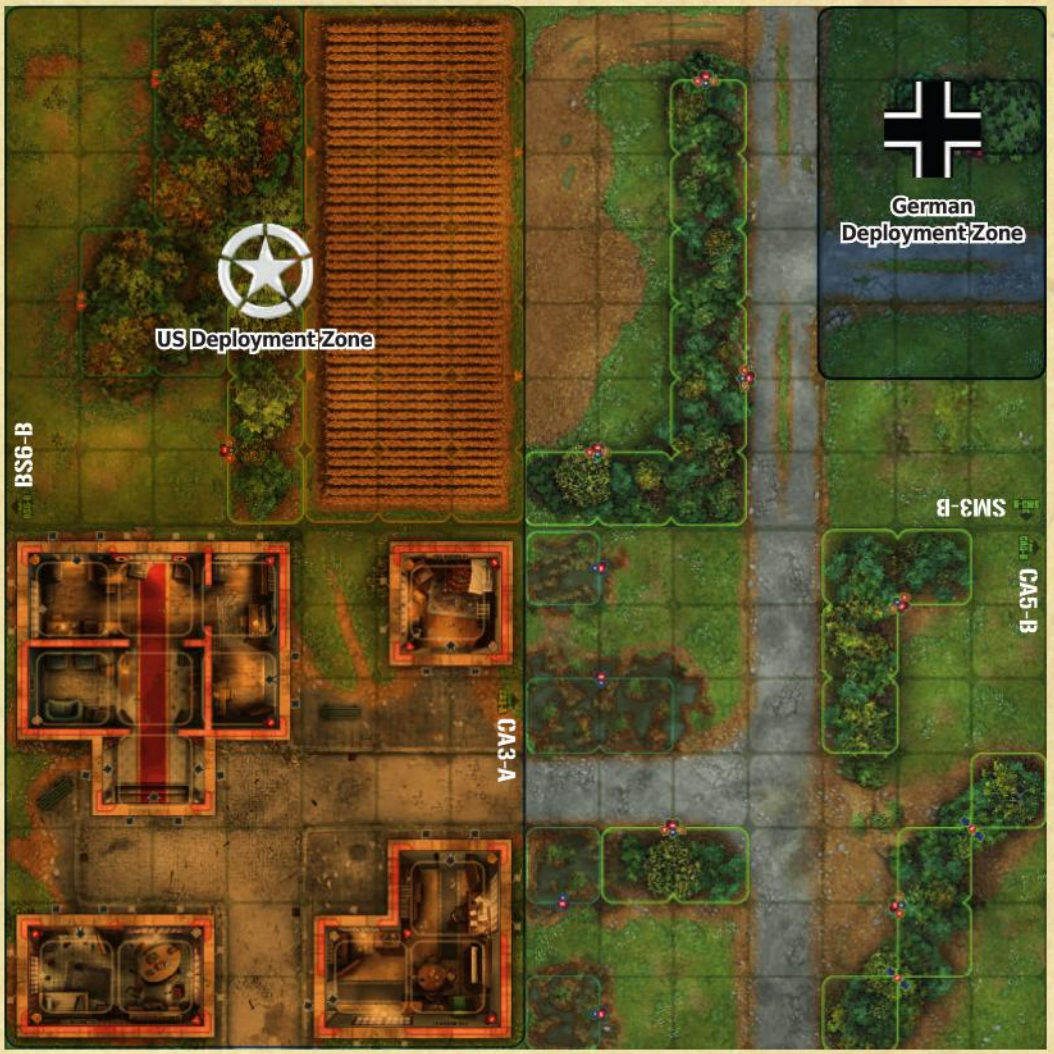
German Victory: the Germans must have **a score of at least three points at the end of the game**. They get one point for every building they control on tile **CA3-A** as well as one point for every **Panther** tank that exits through the left side of the map. So any time a Panther tank manages to escape, one less building needs to be captured in order to score three points.

American Victory: if the Germans fail to achieve their goals by the end of Turn 7.

SCENARIO RULES

The **US 57mm AT Gun** starts the game camouflaged. Its token is not yet deployed as it is completely hidden from the enemy. Secretly write down its location in any convenient manner. The gun is revealed and placed on the map, the first time it fires or when a GE unit has a clear LoS to the gun's position.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

The 406. Infanterie-Division was dealing with elite US troops, so even with tanks to aid them, they gladly welcomed the Fallschirmjägers. The American paratroops resisted valiantly but were outnumbered. At Riethorst two platoons of companies B & C were up against a German battalion supported by three Panthers. Late in the morning, C company found itself isolated as KG Hermann advanced significantly in the northwest sector, reaching the outskirts of Mook, quite near the Heumen bridge.

CAT AND MOUSE IN MOOK

September 20, 1944. Mook 1410 hrs: At 1330 hrs, while he was monitoring the preparations for an assault on Nijmegen, General Gavin got an urgent call from Division HQ.

Due to the German advance, the situation between Mook and Beek was critical, moreover, at Heumen their only available bridge across the Maas/Waal canal was in danger.



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of A & B Companies, 1/505th Parachute Infantry Regiment





Elements of Kampfgruppe Hermann, 406. Infanterie-Division



2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Don't stop, Hit and run, It bounced right off it, Ram, Repairs, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, *Weak Point*,
as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Americans deploy first in their deployment zone but **Lt Col. Cole**, **Schultz** and the **units from the Paratroopers option** enter on the left side of the map no sooner than Turn 4.

Germans have the Initiative.
Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

GE and US (see Scenario Rules).

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

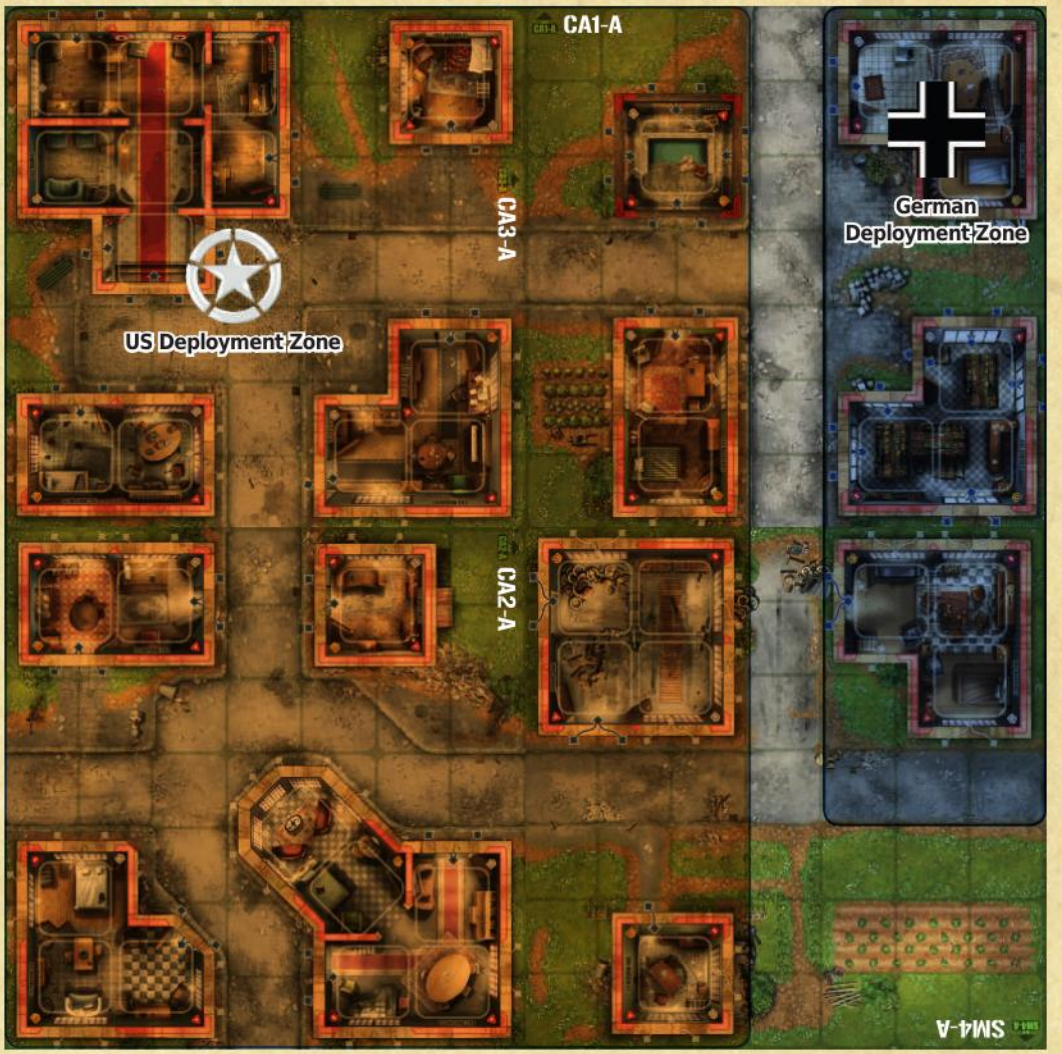
German Victory: if the Germans control at least **eight buildings** in the American deployment zone at the end of the game. Buildings without markers belong to the Americans. Put any available marker on a building once it is controlled by Germans. Remove the marker from buildings retaken by the Americans. Control is kept even if the structure is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control.

American Victory: if the Germans fail to achieve their goals by the end of Turn 7.

SCENARIO RULES

Recon units cannot use their **Scout** ability during deployment.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

Thanks to their superiority in numbers KG Hermann pushed 1/505th into the narrow streets of Mook, but progress was slow. Aided by their Panzers, the Germans broke through the American lines. Even though the men of 1/505th fought like devils, at 1410 hrs, after a game of cat and mouse, Mook was virtually retaken by the Germans. In the center of Mook, two platoons of Company B reinforced with two platoons of Company A (regimental reserve), despite being surrounded, did succeed in holding off the enemy. Mook would switch hands a few more times in the coming days.

NIJMEGEN 44 - SCENARIO 10 - BRIEFING

ALERT AT HEUMEN BRIDGE

September 20, 1944. On the road between Mook and Molenhoek 1700 hrs:

General Gavin: "After leaving Molenhoek we got to a railroad overpass at about 500m north of Mook. To our right was a 20-foot levee, protection against potential swelling of River Maas. Upon approaching the bridge, I heard a great deal of small arms fire. A paratrooper with a bazooka sat in a foxhole, all by himself and apparently in shock. Slightly further stood an abandoned English tank, out of action due to American mines. Captain Olson and Sergeant Wood climbed onto the railroad to engage the enemy. The jeep driver was ordered to step on it and go tell the Coldstream Guards to join us with great haste."



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of 1st & 3rd Battalions, 505th Parachute Infantry Regiment



Elements of 5/Coldstream Guards





ALLIED DEPLOYMENT

US Group 1 is placed in **US Deployment Zone 1**.

US Group 2 is placed in **US Deployment Zone 2**.

US Group 3 enters in **Turn 3** through the **Northside**.

CW Group 4 enters in **Turn 5** through the **Northside**.

Elements of KG Hermann, 406. Infanterie-Division



2- PREPARATION



Remove from the American deck:
all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Americans deploy first.
Following the **Allied Deployment** rules (see above).



Germans have the Initiative.
Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Place a **Sherman wreck** on terrain tile **C3-B**.

Germans enter from the **right side**
through the squares denoted by arrows.

US and GE deployment (see Scenario Rules).

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

German Victory: if the Germans control at least **three Objectives** at the end of the game.

American Victory: if the Germans fail to achieve their goals by the end of Turn 8.

SCENARIO RULES

- **Recon** units cannot use their **Scout** ability during deployment.
- The **Forest** terrain elements on **C5-A** and **BS4-B** are **levees**.
- Once controlled, **Objectives** are not removed from the board. Control is kept even if the Objective is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT



EPILOGUE

The first reinforcements to arrive were the other battalions of the 505th commanded by Colonel Ekman followed soon after by the tanks of 5/Coldstream Guards. Fighting took place about 2000m from the Heumen bridge. After seven hours of combat, whilst the Americans kept sending in extra troops, KG Hermann's offensive lost momentum. Early in the evening, the Germans had to fall back, allowing the Allies to retake Mook, thus relieving B, 1/505th that had been surrounded in the town center.

The Germans who had been pushed out of Riethorst by the Coldstream Guards rallied in the Reichwald under cover of darkness. The US paratroops had held their ground up against a numerically superior force but the Allies were forced to shift their focus and resources towards holding the crossing at Heumen, away from their main Market Garden objectives: the bridges at Nijmegen and Arnhem.

"SLIM JIM" GOES CAMPING

September 17, 1944. North of DZ N 1300 hrs: Because his plane was overloaded with material, General Gavin endured a very rough landing and hurt his back in the process. In spite of this, his highest priority was to set up his HQ (codename "Champion") as planned, in the woods about 2km of Groesbeek. The only available infantry was a unit of Engineers. The group was accompanied by a Dutch liaison officer, Captain Arie Bestebreurtje who had volunteered with the British Special Operations Executive (SOE). He knew the region well and was involved in covert Operation Jedburgh which provided a link between Allied armies and the local resistance...



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Group of General Gavin, 82nd Airborne Division





Elements of Kampfgruppe Henke



2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Bogged Down, *Don't Stop*, *Hit and Run*, *It Bounced Right off It*, *Ram*, *Repairs*, *Return to Sender*, *Surprise*, *Weak Point*, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, *Booby Trapped*, *Don't Stop*, *Hit and Run*, *It Bounced Right off It*, *Ram*, *Repairs*, *Return to Sender*, *Surprise*, *Weak Point*, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Germans deploy first in their deployment zone.

Americans have the Initiative.
Put the US Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Americans enter in Turn 1 through the squares denoted by red arrows in either zone US 1 or US 2.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

Victory goes to the side controlling at least two out of three Objectives at the end of the game.

SCENARIO RULES

- **Lt Col. Vandervoort** has 4 Movement Points instead of 2 as indicated on his counter.
- The **Germans** have control of all Objectives at the start of the game.
- Once controlled, **Objectives** are not removed from the board. Control is kept even if the Objective is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT





EPILOGUE

General Gavin: "*We moved at a steady pace along a sunken road through a dense forest. After about ten minutes, a machine gun opened up on us. We ducked for cover and returned fire.*"

It is quite unusual for a Division Commander to take point like a scout at the head of the troops but Gavin's combat experience was definitely an advantage. Captain Arie Bestebreurtje proved to be a key figure. At Groesbeek he got on the phone, using the proper code, to get in touch with the Dutch resistance in Nijmegen and Arnhem. Their information gave Gavin an idea about the progress of the operation and as soon as Command Post "Champion" was set up, the General contacted his regiments to direct their actions.

THE FIRST COUNTERATTACKS

September 18, 1944. Landing Zone T 1030 hrs: The 508th PIR under Colonel Lindquist was tasked with organizing defenses for the northeastern approaches of the 82nd Airborne. Both 1/508th and 2/508th were dispatched to capture bridges, the former in Nijmegen, the latter at the Maas/Waal canal. This left only 3/508th to secure the hills around Berg and Dal. German 406. Infanterie-Division, mostly consisting of trainees, was hastily sent to fight the 82nd and had gained control of Landing Zone T and part of Drop zone N. At 1030 hrs, 2300 men of Korps Feldt advanced towards the American positions between Groesbeek and Beek. General Gavin ordered 3/508th to secure the LZ and ensure the inbound gliders a friendly welcome.



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of 1/508th, 3/508th Parachute Infantry Regiment and 376th Field Artillery







Elements of Korps Feldt









2- PREPARATION

Remove from the US deck: *Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point,* as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the GE deck: *Booby Trapped, Repairs, Surprise, Weak Point,* as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Americans deploy first in their deployment zone.

Germans have the Initiative. Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

Victory goes to the side controlling at least three out of four Objectives at the end of the game.

DEPLOYMENT

Assign **one of the jeeps** to Group 1.



Assign **the other jeep** to Group 2.

The **US Units** and **Options** of Group 1 start in Turn 1.

In **Turn 5** the US player adds the **P51 Mustang Card** to his hand and US Group 2 now enters the game through either entry zone as well.

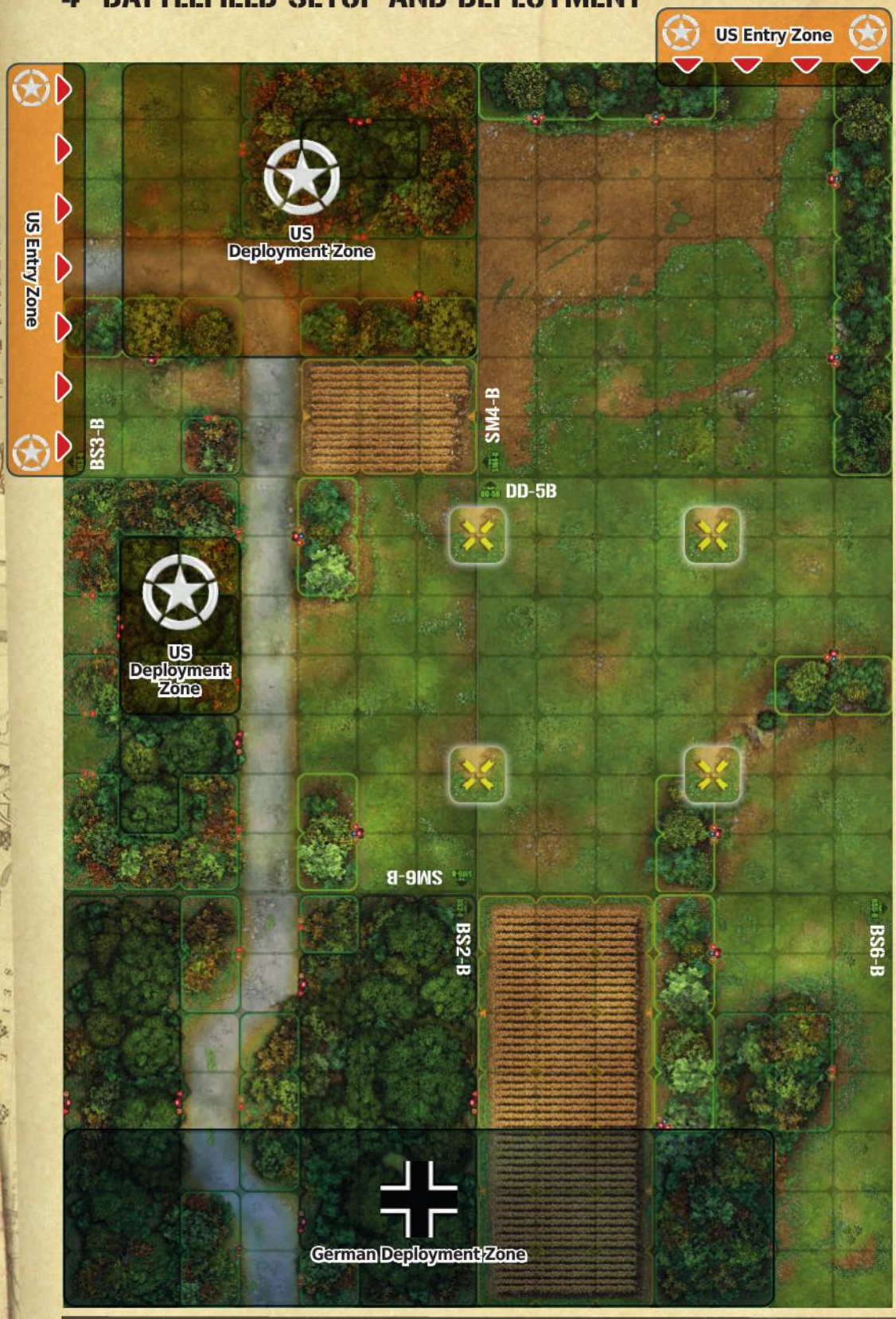


German Feldkommando and **Sd.Kfz. 251/1** enter in **Turn 3**.

SCENARIO RULES

- **Lt Col. Vandervoort** has 4 Movement Points instead of 2 as indicated on his counter.
- Nobody is in control of the **Objectives** at the start of the game.
- Once controlled, **Objectives** are not removed from the board. Control is kept even if the Objective is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control.

4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT





EPILOGUE

The German 406. Infanterie-Division crossed the border close to the town of Wyler and headed towards Nijmegen. Though being commanded by a cadre with a decent level of experience, this division comprised a mix of trainees, Luftwaffe personnel and soldiers with digestive ailments. Little was gained despite their tank support as these inexperienced troops were no match for the Airborne veterans. Major Rash was sent over to rekindle the German offensive. In order to aid 3/508th in securing LZ T, General Gavin had ordered the return of 1/508th who had to cover 7km at the double after spending all night in combat. A rumble roared from the sky, once more filled with aircraft: Second Lift was underway. Thoroughly strafed by Allied fighter planes and likewise peppered with the 75mm shells of the 376th Artillery, the Germans lost their taste for assault. They fell back with companies of the 508th hot on their trail.

GUNFIRE IN A BORDERTOWN

September 19, 1944. Nighttime at Wyler: When a company of 3/508th approached the town of Wyler, they came under sustained fire. Taken by surprise at first, the 82nd didn't understand the reason for such a violent reaction until they realized this small village straddled the Germano-Dutch border. Fierce resistance was to be expected. The Americans set up a roadblock at first but the town could not be held without unacceptable losses for a division whose lines were already stretched to the limit. Wyler was going to be a problem...



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of B Company, 1/508th Parachute Infantry Regiment







Elements of 1. Kompanie, 526. Infanterie-Batallion Korps Feldt











2- PREPARATION



Remove from the American deck:
Don't stop, Hit and run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Repairs, Return to Sender, Weak Point, as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.



Germans have the Initiative.
Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Both sides deploy simultaneously.
Put a screen on the board to keep the initial setup concealed.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.

3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY



Victory goes to the side controlling at least three buildings at the end of the game.

SCENARIO RULES



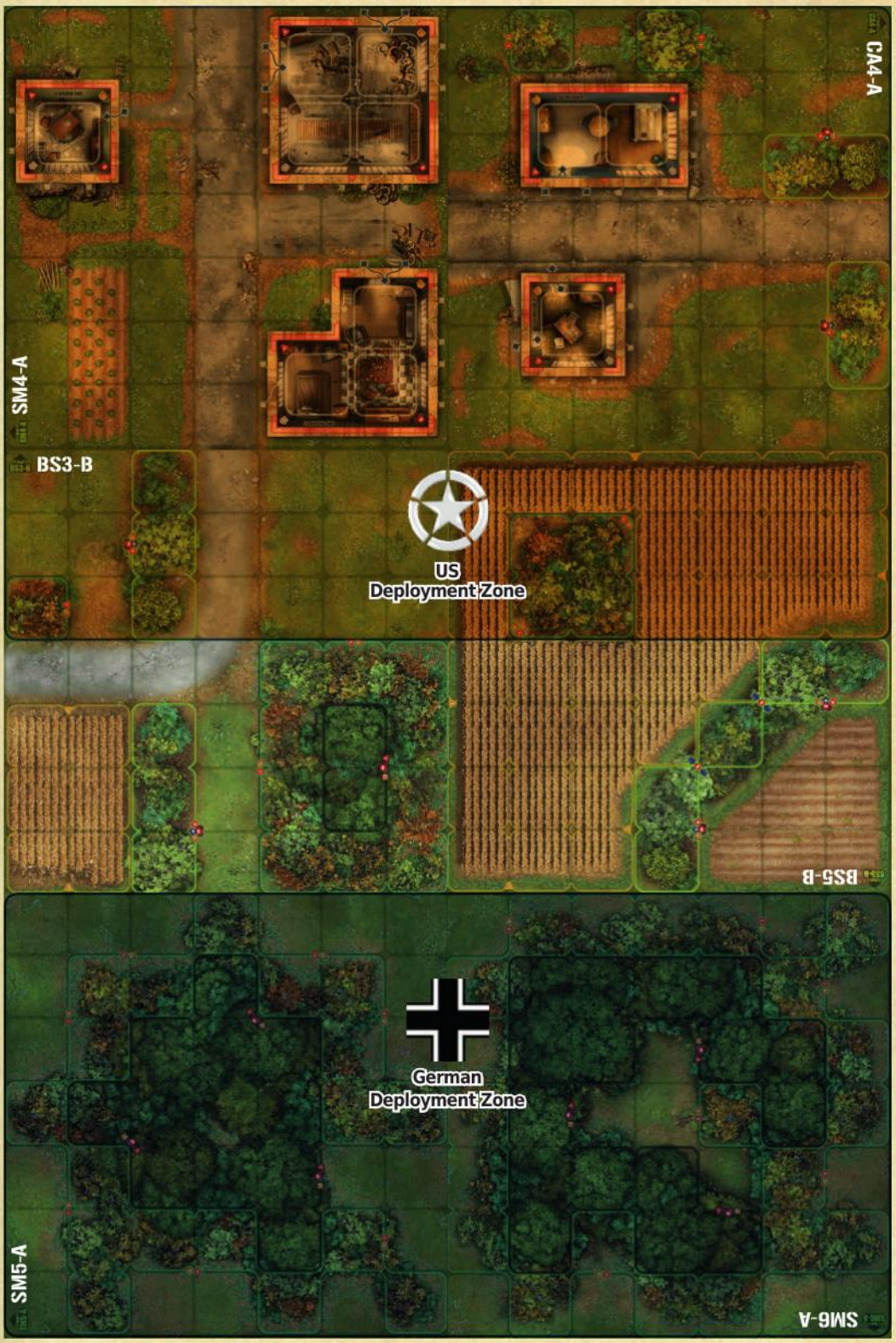
- **Dark Night** conditions apply.
- When one side takes control of a building, one of that faction's **Objective Markers** is placed upon the structure. Control is kept even if the Objective is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control. Replace the Objective Marker with one of the other side if needed.
- **Recon** units cannot use their **Scout** ability during deployment.



- The German player is allocated **5 Order Tokens** (**3 Numbered** and **2 Bluff Order Tokens**). Disregard the total number of stars featured on the Recruitment Tiles.



4- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT







EPILOGUE

The town of Wyler was the scene of many typical actions like that of Corporal Boccafogli of B 1/508th:

"I was on patrol in Wyler with Lt Gleim and Private Mendez. We had gone across the town and nobody was to be seen, not even a cat or dog. Not a sound was heard... it was just too quiet. After reporting back at Captain Millsaps, we were ordered to set up a roadblock at the eastern exit of the township. We took up positions near a road leading up to some woods where Germans were supposed to be hiding. We peered into the darkness but the hours passed without anything stirring. Around daybreak, I could hear the faint roar of an engine coming from the woods. I prepared and loaded the grenade launcher, well aware that such ordnance would not suffice to take out a panzer but it would alert the 57mm gun on the hill at the other side of the village. As a truck full of Germans emerged from behind the trees, my shot fell short but our gun hit the target causing any survivors to run for it, back into the woods."

WARFARE IN WYLER

September 20, 1944. The Town of Wyler: The German advance in Wyler was part of a general attack on the northeastern and eastern front of the 82nd Airborne by the three Kampfgruppen of Korps Feldt. Unlike the previous assaults, this one was much better organized and it put great pressure on the already undermanned company B of the 508th.



1- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

Elements of B Company, 1/508th Parachute Infantry Regiment



Elements of 1. Kompanie, 526. Infanterie-Batallion Korps Feldt



2- PREPARATION

Remove from the American deck:
Don't stop, Hit and run, It Bounced Right off It, Ram, Repairs, Weak Point,
as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Remove from the German deck:
Bogged Down, Repairs, Return to Sender, Weak Point,
as well as all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

Germans have the Initiative.
Put the GE Initiative counter on Turn 1 of the turn chart.

Both sides deploy simultaneously.
Put a screen on the board to keep the initial setup concealed.

Each player draws **4** Action Cards.



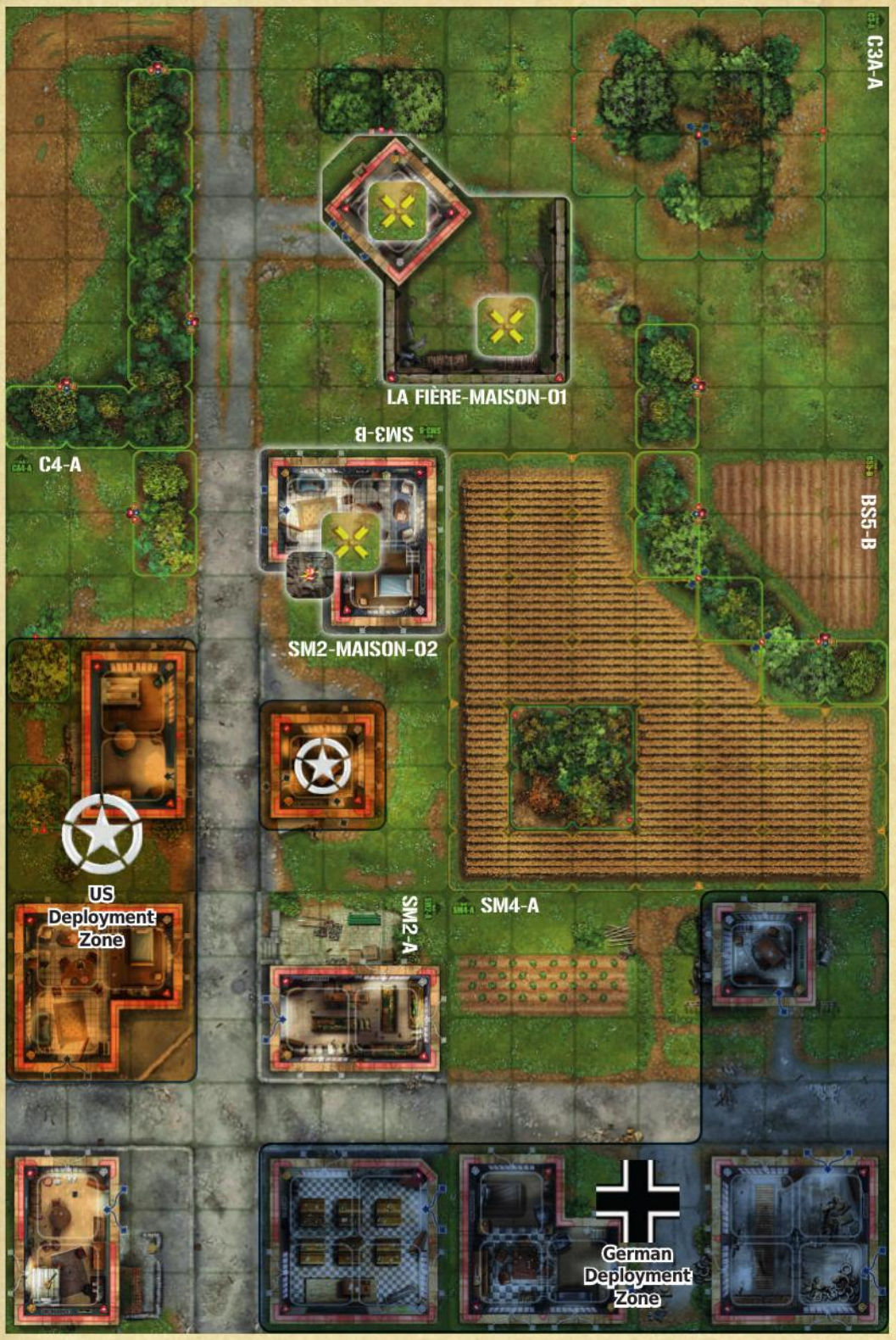
3- END OF GAME AND VICTORY

Victory goes to the side controlling at least two Objectives at the end of the game.

SCENARIO RULES

- Once controlled, **Objectives** are not removed from the board. Control is kept even if the Objective is left unattended, as long as no enemy unit fulfills the conditions to take control.
- Building **SME-MAISON-02** on tile **CA4-A** has already suffered **two Destruction Points** at the start of the scenario. Place the appropriate marker on the building to denote this.

  In case the building is completely destroyed it is considered to have **caught fire**. Any units that happen to be inside at that time receive **two Suppressed Markers** and are placed outside the house on the nearest free square. If the house is thus destroyed, the Objective has also gone up in flames.





EPILOGUE

Although they weren't giving up any house without a fight, company B was forced to retreat into the Dutch part of Wyler in the afternoon. Corporal Boccafogli and his squad found themselves behind the wall facing the barn through which they had left the town. *"Private Herbert Ellerbusch performed a heroic feat, crawling along the wall to get a good shot with his bazooka. The projectile set fire to the barn forcing the Germans outside. Some of them surrendered, others fell back into the town. Alas, Private Ellerbusch was mortally wounded in the process."*

Despite the progress of September 18, the counterattack of the 406. Infanterie-Division faded out. Even so, B 1/508th was allowed to reposition in the adjacent hills.